

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



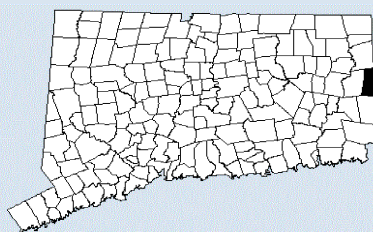
Sterling School District

Theodore Friend, Superintendent • 860-564-4219 • <http://www.sterlingschool.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-8
Number of Schools/Programs	1
Enrollment	328
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$19,662
Total Expenditures ¹	\$9,123,351

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

Contents

Students.....	1
Educators.....	2
Instruction and Resources.....	2
Performance and Accountability.....	4
Narratives.....	6

Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	161	49.1	48.3
Male	167	50.9	51.5
Non-Binary	0	0.0	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.2
Asian	*	*	5.2
Black or African American	7	2.1	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	31	9.5	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	28	8.5	4.7
White	259	79.0	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	117	35.7	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	63	19.2	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	39	26.4	7	4.1
Male	25	17.1	9	5.0
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*	0	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	10	37.0	*	*
White	46	20.0	13	4.8
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	0	0.0	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	29	25.0	10	7.4
Students with Disabilities	19	29.2	8	9.9
District	64	21.8	16	4.6
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 9

Number of school-based arrests: 0

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Sterling School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	25.8
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	9.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	5.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	6.9
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	2.4
School Level	1.5
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	0.0
Support Staff	0.9
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	1.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	3.5
School Nurses	1.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	28.1

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	0	0.0	1.4
Black or African American	0	0.0	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	2	5.0	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.3
White	38	95.0	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	14.7	13.3

Instruction and Resources

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers²

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	*	*
Emotional Disability	*	*
Intellectual Disability	0	0
Learning Disability	24	75.0
Other Health Impairment	10	*
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	8	*
District	49	57.6
State		66.8

² This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Sterling School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	15	3.4	2.6
Emotional Disability	*	*	1.1
Intellectual Disability	*	*	0.6
Learning Disability	32	7.3	6.4
Other Health Impairment	17	3.9	3.5
Other Disabilities	*	*	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	11	2.5	2.0
All Disabilities	85	19.5	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	28	32.9	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	8	9.4	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$6,496,469	\$14,001	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$138,731	\$440	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$298,400	\$947	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$325,777	\$1,034	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$377,559	\$1,199	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$144,222	\$458	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$553,255	\$1,756	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$711,793	\$1,325	\$1,582
Food services	\$26,730	\$85	\$8
Enterprise operations	\$50,414	\$160	\$213
Total	\$9,123,351	\$19,662	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$705,551	27.0	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$278,201	10.6	10.2
Other Salaries	\$88,408	3.4	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$299,613	11.5	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$58,066	2.2	6.4
Special Education Tuition	\$1,138,265	43.5	22.2
Supplies	\$40,312	1.5	0.7
Property Services	\$1,929	0.1	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$981	0.0	8.4
Equipment	\$1,535	0.1	0.3
All Other Expenditures	\$1,008	0.0	0.1
Total	\$2,613,868	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		28.7	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	54.2
State	38.6
Federal	6.0
Tuition & Other	1.2

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Sterling School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	*	*
Asian	*	*	*	*	*	*
Black or African American	*	*	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	18	*	18	*	*	*
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Two or More Races	18	*	18	*	*	*
White	148	60.4	148	51.3	52	55.3
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	190	60.4	190	51.1	65	55.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	72	56.1	72	47.0	24	50.1
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	118	62.9	118	53.6	41	58.4
Students with Disabilities	41	42.3	41	36.5	13	*
Students without Disabilities	149	65.3	149	55.2	52	58.3
High Needs	89	54.3	89	46.0	29	51.4
Non-High Needs	101	65.7	101	55.7	36	58.5
District	190	60.4	190	51.1	65	55.3

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	58.3	65.4	70.7	N/A	103	65.0
Curl Up	86.1	84.6	75.0	N/A	102	81.4
Push Up	80.0	65.4	63.4	N/A	102	69.6
Mile Run/PACER	58.3	53.8	35.7	N/A	104	48.1
All Tests - District	37.1	30.8	17.5	N/A	101	27.7
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Sterling School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	60.4	75	40.2	50	80.5	63.9
	High Needs Students	54.3	75	36.2	50	72.4	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	51.1	75	34.1	50	68.2	60.2
	High Needs Students	46.0	75	30.7	50	61.3	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	55.3	75	36.9	50	73.8	61.8
	High Needs Students	51.4	75	34.2	50	68.5	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	54.2%	100%	54.2	100	54.2	58.7%
	High Needs Students	55.6%	100%	55.6	100	55.6	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	40.9%	100%	40.9	100	40.9	61.4%
	High Needs Students	43.6%	100%	43.6	100	43.6	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	.	100%	.	.	.	58.9%
	Oral	.	100%	.	.	.	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	21.8%	<=5%	16.5	50	32.9	17.7%
	High Needs Students	24.7%	<=5%	10.7	50	21.3	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	.	75%	.	.	.	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	.	75%	.	.	.	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		87.9%	94%	46.7	50	93.5	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		.	94%	.	.	.	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		.	94%	.	.	.	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		.	75%	.	.	.	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		93.5% 27.7%	75%	18.5	50	37.0	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		.	60%	.	.	.	55.0%
Accountability Index				499.0	900	55.4	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	65.7	54.3	11.4	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	55.7	46.0	9.7	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	58.5	51.4	7.1	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	.	.	.	.	

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	99.0
	High Needs Students	97.8
Math	All Students	99.0
	High Needs Students	97.8
Science	All Students	98.6
	High Needs Students	96.8

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: * **State: 49.7**

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Sterling School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

The Sterling School District welcomes families into the building at multiple points throughout the school year. Front office staff are available and greet all incoming families while also responding to any questions they may have. The school has responded to parent surveys and continue to provide information to families. Sterling School is part of the Northeast Early Childhood Council which is a collaborative with eight communities. It serves as the School Readiness Council and brings statewide resources to our families and educators.

Sterling School district employs reading and math intervention and social emotional supports for students. The District has a comprehensive school SRBI framework that are data informed and take into consideration proactive strategies to address student needs throughout all tiers of instruction. The District has developed a Strategic Plan that includes personalized learning for students and staff as a focus, and that emphasizes student competencies and progressions as communicated via learning targets and individual goal setting with students and staff.

The District has made efforts to improve student attendance. The attendance review committee meets regularly to review attendance data and remediate attendance concerns in a timely manner. The attendance review committee includes school administration, the social worker, school administrative assistant, and the school nurse who plan action steps to support families with school attendance.

In an effort to engage parents in the planning and improvement of school programs, parents continue to be invited to participate on committees that seek to advance the goals of the District Strategic Plan. Parents' input is sought when rolling out new initiatives and feedback is solicited via surveys, newsletters and social media. The District continues to improve the website to make it more user friendly for parents, students, staff, and community members.

The District works to support parents at home by encouraging regular communication and collaboration with families. Teachers reach out regularly to parents via emails, newsletters, and phone calls to communicate what is happening in the classroom settings as well as to provide assistance and guidance to parents in areas where they may be seeking assistance, such as homework, understanding developmental milestones and learning progressions, essential learning standards and mastery based learning expectations.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Sterling Community School continues to provide content and curriculum that increases student awareness of cultural and individual diversity. Curriculum provides a focus on world culture and customs. In addition, the District continues to implement SEL curriculum and content that draws from the core CASEL competencies in an effort to improve overall social awareness, self-awareness, relationship skills and responsible decision making all through a lens of empathy and compassion for others. Events are scheduled throughout the year to promote and celebrate diversity that is aligned with the District's curriculum standards.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Sterling School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

Sterling Community School currently has an enrollment of 315 students in grades PreK to grade 8. Sterling Community School is a one school district. Secondary students in grades 9 - 12 attend various high schools including Plainfield High School (designated), Killingly Vo-Ag, the area Technical High Schools, ACT Magnet High School and Quinebaug Valley Middle College. Tuition is designated by each high school and the remaining budget is spent on Sterling Community School.